

SNIPPETS

Unique IDs from Feb 2011

The Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) would start issuing the 16-digit unique identity number to each resident of the country in February 2011. These numbers will be based on 11 biometrics, including 10 fingerprints and the iris. The unique number will enable the UIDAI to verify identity of a citizen online and India will become the first country in the world to have such a system.

Infotech Enterprises to buy IDT's Indian unit

Infotech Enterprises will take over the India design office of the US chip maker IDT Inc. for "no payment". According to the agreement, the workstations and 32 engineers working for IDT in Hyderabad will be taken over by Infotech. Infotech will also integrate the captive business process outsourcing centre into its hitech business unit, which primarily designs chips.

Number portability pushed to May 2010

The much-awaited mobile number portability (MNP) could face further delays with the home ministry raising concerns that US-based Telcordia Technologies (one of the two companies selected to implement MNP here) has no experience in running telecom operations. State-owned BSNL and MTNL have also not completed upgrading their networks to enable MNP. The government had earlier set end December 2009 as deadline for the implementation of the MNP regime for the metros.

Kerala to invest Rs 20 billion in IT infrastructure

With an aim to make Kerala the most sought after IT destination in the country, the state government has proposed to invest Rs 20 billion during 2009-11 for development of infrastructure at the IT parks being set up in various parts of the state. Kerala offers world of opportunities for IT companies with lower cost of operations.

LG Electronics stops PC production

LG Electronics has stopped the production of personal computers (PCs) and is fully outsourcing it to local and Taiwanese companies. The company is shutting down laptop production at its plant in Kunshan, China, where it will now manufacture vehicle navigation systems.

development. The ability to move about resources based on business needs would give it the benefits of greater return on investment and utilisation.

In addition, adopting the platform would improve its operational excellence; IBM hardware and software would help enhance efficiency by incorporating automation elements for better manageability.

Sony to consolidate international distribution operations

Sony Corp. plans to consolidate its international distribution operations with those of its video-games unit this fiscal year to reduce overlapping costs.

The Tokyo-based company and Sony Computer Entertainment, which sells PlayStation 3 software and hardware, will combine distribution routes and jointly bid for contracts.

The cost of distributing products for the group is expected to rise 50 per cent next fiscal year. The company is targeting a 5 per cent operating margin, the percentage of sales left after deducting the cost of goods sold and administrative expenses, by March 2013.

ATIC completes Chartered acquisition

Abu Dhabi-based Advanced Technology Investment Company (ATIC) has completed the acquisition of Singapore's Chartered Semiconductor

Manufacturing Ltd. Now, Chartered will be integrated with the operations of chip maker GlobalFoundries, a joint venture between AMD and ATIC.

Chartered will be delisted from the Nasdaq and the SGX (Singapore exchange). The company will also be de-registered from the US Securities Exchange Commission in due course. The American Depositary Share (ADS) programme of Chartered will be terminated, and the ADSs will cease trading.

ATIC made its acquisition by way of a scheme of arrangement, and Chartered ordinary shareholders approved the acquisition last month.

IBM offers smarter education solutions

IBM, along with its partners Merce Technologies and Focuz, has announced new offerings to drive 'smarter education in Pune.' Built for academic institutions, trusts and professional colleges, these smarter education solutions embrace technologies such as cloud computing, open source systems, virtualisation and analytics, and help transform educational systems.

"There has never been a better time to make our education technology systems smarter," said Ramesh Narasimhan, director, general business, IBM India/South Asia. "With better management, measurement and processes, the effectiveness of school systems could be raised significantly at the existing spending levels."

"This will help educational institutions delivering a better academic environment to their students and faculty, strengthening relationships with alumni and recruiters, enhancing brand image and differentiating themselves as forward-thinking centres of academic excellence," said Shuvam Misra, founder and chief executive officer, Merce Technologies.

Through technology based in cloud computing, every student in schools, colleges and universities can access the most advanced educational content, software applications, and computing and storage resources.